However, before that, the chapter explores how Russia and China's relations have evolved.

Russia's Shift Toward China

Since the division of the Soviet Union, there were two kinds of policymakers within the Russian Federation. Firstly, these included the Western supporters who wanted to ally with the traditional West-dominated institutions, and secondly, the Sinophile discourse supporters (or those who supported and focused on China). These two groups influenced policymaking in the Russian Federation, but Western discourse support groups still managed to gather more say, as they were in the majority. Gradually, the tendency shifted to the East, focusing on China and the Sinophiles discourse group. Yet, even within the Chinese discourse supporters, there was further groupism. According to scholar Tsigankov (2009), there were two divisions in the Russian discourse of China, which included the 'pragmatists' and the 'ideologists.'

Pragmatists

The pragmatists supported the enhancement of relations within economic and security affairs. They believe that Russia's preservation of sovereignty and independence, and its emphasis, would be better protected through closer economic and political relations. For example, Karaganov (2010) argued that Russia should think pragmatically, focus on building its 'hard power' (or *realpolitik*) capacity and military force, particularly given NATO's strict control over the Russian territory. In this context, Russia was advised to build relations with China and other like-minded states who could help Russia when needed. Further, the leading Russian intellectual Vadim Tsymburski (2001) stated that Russia must preserve its control over its geopolitical responsibility area, mainly Central Asia and the Caucasus. He further advised that it should be followed by developing its political, cultural, and economic relations with China, India, and Iran.

Furthermore, in 2003, the then Chair of the International Affairs Committee in the Federal Council, Mikhail Margelov, stressed the Sino–Russian nexus in the Russia–US triangle (Lo 2008: 163). The 'Russian Doctrine' was also prepared by renowned Russian scholars in 2007,